San Fermo Employee Handbook

Back of House Edition — General Policies and Procedures

1. Company Description and Hours

San Fermo is a full-service restaurant, currently open for dinner 7 nights a week. These hours may vary from time to time due to special event schedules and holidays. We typically close for 4th of July, Thanksgiving, Christmas Day, and New Year's Day. Further closures will be announced in advance when possible. Occasionally it may be necessary to close with short notice due to facility issues, power outages, utility problems, or other emergencies. San Fermo does not offer hourly pay for periods when the restaurant is closed.

2. Equal Employment Opportunity

San Fermo will not discriminate because of race, religion, color, sex, age, creed, national origin, marital status, sexual orientation, gender identity, physical or mental disability, or any other non-merit factor. This policy relates to all phases of employment, including but not limited to: recruiting, hiring, promotion, demotion, layoff, termination, rates of pay, and other forms of compensation. In handling physical and mental disabilities, San Fermo will make reasonable accommodations in accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act and other relevant law.

3. Job Requirements

When hiring for a specific position, the general requirements will be made clear to prospective candidates. These requirements may include: physical and ambulatory abilities, communication skills, language skills, schedule availability, competency within a nuanced or skilled role, proficiency with equipment, and ability to maintain sustained productivity during general working conditions. If an employee's ability to perform necessary job requirements changes during their employment, San Fermo will work to accommodate; however, all employees will understand and agree that such changes may drastically reduce or eliminate their hours worked, and in some cases, their wage or compensation may change based on a new role.

4. Service Charge and BOH Wages

San Fermo charges a 23% Service Charge on all pre-tax sales. This revenue is retained by the restaurant to support hourly wages and salaries across the entire team, including Back of House staff. San Fermo actively discourages tipping from customers. The Service Charge supports a fair wage model throughout the restaurant. BOH employees are compensated at their agreed hourly rate, which reflects the revenue generated by the Service Charge. In some cases, employees may receive voluntary tips from customers; any such gratuity must be reported to management for proper income reporting to the Internal Revenue Service. The practice of actively soliciting tips will not be tolerated and may be grounds for disciplinary action, including immediate termination.

5. BOH Compensation and Structure

Back of House employees at San Fermo are compensated at an agreed hourly rate. Unlike Front of House positions, BOH employees do not receive a shift sales commission — your wage is designed to reflect the Service Charge model and the skill level of your role. Pay periods are semi-monthly. Direct deposit is required and must be set up before your first paycheck. Any questions about your pay, hours, or deductions should be directed to your supervisor or operating management.

Overtime is governed by Washington State law. Shifts of more than 10 hours require management approval in advance. Do not clock in early or stay late without explicit authorization. Unauthorized overtime will be flagged and may result in disciplinary action.

6. Kitchen Standards and Expectations

Kitchen Hierarchy

The kitchen at San Fermo operates under a clear chain of command. Respect for that structure is non-negotiable. Direction flows as follows:

- Operating Partner / Chef: Samuel West
- Chef de Cuisine: Chris Hoey
- Sous Chef: Jose Agundez
- Line Cooks and Prep Cooks

Instructions from any member of management are to be followed promptly and professionally. Questions and concerns are always welcome — bring them to your direct supervisor first.

Arrival and Pre-Shift Expectations

- Arrive in uniform and ready to work at your scheduled start time. Clock in only at your scheduled time — not before.
- Review the nightly prep list, specials, and any 86'd items before service begins.
- Set your station fully before the first ticket drops. Mise en place is your responsibility.
- Communicate any shortages, equipment issues, or concerns to the Sous Chef or CDC before service, not during.

Uniform and Appearance

- Clean chef whites or kitchen-approved attire required every shift. No exceptions.
- Non-slip, closed-toe shoes are mandatory. Clogs and kitchen sneakers are acceptable; running shoes and open-toed footwear are not.
- Hair must be tied back and/or covered. Beards must be kept neat; beard nets are available and may be required.
- No excessive jewelry. Rings, bracelets, and watches are a food safety hazard and must be removed before service.

Station and Kitchen Conduct

- Your station is your responsibility: set it up, maintain it through service, and break it down completely at end of shift.
- Label, date, and properly store all food. Follow FIFO (first in, first out) at all times.
- Call your moves — "behind," "corner," "hot," "sharp" — every time, without exception.
- Keep noise at a functional level. Music volume, side conversations, and personal phone use are managed at management's discretion.
- Personal phones are not permitted on the line during service. Keep them in your bag or locker.
- Tasting is part of the job — use a clean spoon every time and dispose of it properly.
- Eating a full meal on shift is permitted during pre-service or family meal. Do not eat from the line during service.

Training Period

All new BOH hires complete a structured training period before working independently on the line.

- Training consists of a minimum of 4 training shifts on your assigned station.
- Your first station assignment will be agreed upon before your first shift. Be honest about your readiness — it's always better to start where you're confident and build from there.
- After your training shifts, you will be evaluated for sign-off. If additional time is needed on a station, that will be communicated without judgment.
- Cross-training across all BOH stations is the long-term expectation. Every cook at San Fermo works toward full-kitchen fluency over time.
- Ask questions during training. No question is too basic. The kitchen is a safer and more consistent place when everyone speaks up.

End of Shift

- Complete all breakdown and cleaning tasks assigned to your station before clocking out.
- Wrap, label, and store all remaining product. Nothing goes out uncovered or unlabeled.
- Do a final walk of your station with the closing Sous Chef or CDC before leaving.
- Clock out at the actual time you finish — not before breakdown is complete.

7. Prohibited Conduct

In order to assure orderly operations and provide the best possible work environment, San Fermo expects Employees to follow rules of conduct that will protect workplace safety and compliance with various statutes and regulations that govern our industry. It is not possible to list all the forms of behavior that are considered unacceptable in the workplace, but the following are examples of infractions of rules of conduct that may result in disciplinary action, including suspension, demotion, or immediate termination:

A. **Theft** – This is unacceptable at San Fermo, and any employee caught stealing or misappropriating company property will be subject to immediate termination. Theft is further defined as follows:
   - Physically taking anything not belonging to you, whether from the company, coworker, guest, or vendor.
   - Falsifying and or altering inventory numbers or sales for personal benefit.
   - Taking or "borrowing" money from the cash till.
   - Falsifying time records reported for payroll.
   - Altering sales tickets for financial gain.

B. **Violence in the workplace** – San Fermo has a zero-tolerance policy for violence. Any employee who engages in any violence in the workplace or threatens violence in or outside the workplace will be subject to immediate termination. No talk of violence or joking about violence will be tolerated.

C. **Drinking alcohol during your shift** – Any level of alcohol consumption while working is specifically prohibited by the Washington State Liquor Control Board and grounds for immediate termination. Exceptions are made for wine and spirits tastings conducted or approved by management.

D. **Being under the influence of alcohol or recreational drugs when arriving for work** – If you are found to be under the influence and impaired, you will be sent home and subject to disciplinary action or immediate termination. Drugs prescribed by a physician that impair your mental state must be brought to the attention of management before coming to work. San Fermo reserves the right to prevent employees from working under the influence of any substance that could negatively impact the safety of an employee or their peers and guests.

E. **Falsification of employment records** – Falsifying employment information or other records are grounds for immediate termination.

F. **Removing or borrowing San Fermo property** – Taking property without prior authorization represents risk of immediate termination.

G. **Insubordination** – This includes but is not limited to failure or refusal to obey the orders or instructions of any Manager or member of Management, or the use of abusive or threatening language toward any Manager or member of Management.

H. **Failure to notify the appropriate Manager when unable to report to work** – If you are unable to report to work, you must notify your manager at least 2 hours before you are scheduled to commence work. Cell phone texting is not an appropriate form of communicating your absence to your manager.

I. **Failure to obtain permission to leave work** for any reason during normal work hours.

J. **Abusing or falsifying accounts** for paid sick leave.

K. **Committing a fraudulent act or breach of trust** under any circumstances.

Employment may be terminated at will either by the Employee or San Fermo at any time, without following any formal system of discipline or warning. San Fermo may exercise its discretion to utilize forms of discipline that are less severe than termination. Examples of less severe forms of discipline include verbal warnings, written warnings, demotions, and suspensions.

Alcohol Service Standards

Back of House. These standards supplement Section 7, Prohibited Conduct, item C. The kitchen does not serve alcohol, but the restaurant's liquor license covers every employee on the premises, and several of our house rules are stricter than Washington law by design.

Staff Consumption

No employee consumes alcohol or uses drugs during a shift, in the kitchen or anywhere on the premises. A shift drink may be served only after you have clocked out. Tastings conducted or approved by management are the only exception. Violation is grounds for immediate termination, consistent with Section 7.

Serving Guests

Kitchen staff do not serve, pour, or hand alcohol to guests, including at the pass, on the patio, or during Mercato service. If a guest asks you for a drink, find their server or the manager on duty. A MAST permit is not required for kitchen roles; if you are ever assigned to a role that serves alcohol, you will need one before your first such shift.

What the Floor Is Doing

So that the whole house works from the same standard: the floor checks identification for any guest who appears under 50, checks every guest at a table that orders a bottle of wine, cuts off any guest showing signs of intoxication, and asks any table found sharing alcohol with an underage guest to leave. If you notice any of these situations from the kitchen or the pass, tell the manager on duty rather than handling it yourself.

Non-Alcoholic Items

Non-alcoholic beverages are rung and listed as their own items. Beer under 0.5% ABV is served to adults only. House-made sodas and syrups prepared in the kitchen contain no alcohol unless a manager has approved a recipe that does, in which case it is rung and served as alcohol.

Talking With Guests

Do not discuss enforcement activity, inspections, or violations with guests. If asked, San Fermo follows Washington State Liquor and Cannabis Board requirements and house policy to protect its license.

The full standards are posted in the staff portal under Compliance, where every employee reads and signs them. Revised October 2026.

8. Open Door Policy

San Fermo recognizes that Employees will have suggestions for improving the workplace, as well as complaints about the workplace. The most satisfactory solution to a job-related problem or concern is usually reached through a prompt discussion with your Manager. Please feel free to contact your Manager with any suggestions and/or complaints. If you do not feel comfortable contacting your Manager or are not satisfied with your Manager's response, please submit your complaint or suggestion in writing to the Operating Partner who will review your written submission and provide you with a final resolution. San Fermo believes that open communication is essential to a successful work environment and all employees should feel free to raise issues of concern without fear of reprisal.

9. Unlawful Harassment

It is San Fermo's policy to provide a work environment based on mutual respect, and one that encourages productive and cooperative work. Harassment based on an employee's race, sex, color, national origin, ancestry, religion, creed, physical or mental disability, age, sexual orientation, or any other basis protected by federal, state, or local law is inconsistent with that policy and will not be tolerated. Harassment includes, but is not limited to, slurs, jokes, teasing, or name calling directed at one of the above categories. San Fermo will not tolerate harassment and will promptly investigate and address all reported allegations.

A. Sexual Harassment Defined: Applicable state and federal law defines sexual harassment as unwanted sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or visual, verbal, or physical conduct of a sexual nature when: (1) submission to the conduct is made a term or condition of employment; (2) submission to or rejection of the conduct is used as a basis for employment decisions; or (3) the conduct has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with the employee's work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment.

B. Complaint Procedure: If you believe you have been harassed on the job, or are aware of the harassment of others, provide a written or verbal complaint to your Manager, any other Manager, or the Operating Partner as soon as possible. Include names of individuals involved, names of any witnesses, direct quotations when language is relevant, and any documentary evidence. All complaints will be investigated impartially, promptly, thoroughly, and as confidentially as possible. San Fermo prohibits retaliation against any employee for filing a complaint or cooperating in an investigation.

10. Employee Acknowledgment Form

Since the information and policies described here are necessarily subject to change, I acknowledge that revisions may occur. All such changes will be communicated through official notices, and I understand that revised information may supersede, modify, or eliminate existing policies. Only the Operating Partner of San Fermo has the ability to adopt any revisions to the policies.

11. Hourly Sick/Safe Time (SST) and PTO

- Based on anniversary year.
- Accrual based on 1 hour for every 40 hours worked.
- Ineligible for the first 90 days after hire date.
- Up to 40 hours rolls over to next anniversary year.

- Not cashed out when employee leaves or is terminated.
- Managers to track sick time and adjust hours available.
- Sick/Safe Time is paid out on the average hours worked from previous same-shift records.
- Use of SST hours for voluntary time off may be approved by the Manager based on advance notice.

Paid Sick and Safe Time Policy – Personal illness or preventative care. Care for a family member's illness or preventative care (child, grandparent, parent, parent-in-law, spouse and registered domestic partner). Survivors of domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking; closure of workplace or child's school by a public official to limit exposure to infectious agent, biological toxin, or hazardous material.

Notification Policy – If you are unable to work your shift, contact your manager immediately by phone. Texting or emailing is not acceptable. If your condition prevents you from coming to work for additional shifts, contact your manager as soon as possible to allow for proper coverage. Failure to provide notification may result in disciplinary action. If you miss more than three consecutive shifts you may be required to provide documentation from a healthcare professional.

Signature

Date